

HP Photosmart 130

A cute little photo printer

If you own a digital camera and want a printer to print directly from it, consider the Photosmart 130. It is a specialised photo printer, unlike others which are just conventional inkjet printers with improvised photo printing capabilities. It comprises an LCD display, a collapsible paper feeder, a cartridge compartment and rubberised buttons. It is USB 2.0 ready and compatible with different types of memory. The only sore point is that IBM's Microdrives are not supported.

If you have an HP direct-printing compatible camera, you can directly hook the camera to the printer. However, you can only print photos measuring up to 4x6 inches. Images can be printed in both JPEG and TIFF format at a resolution of up to 4800x1200 in the automatic mode. The LCD is small and does not allow a

preview of the photo and is divided into two parts—one for displaying the status and the other for displaying the printer setup information. It also sports a backlight. One sore point is the missing USB cable.

We tested the printing quality and the time taken using the accompanying HP special glossy paper for the automatic mode, in which the printer selects the best resolution by itself. The 4x6-inch borderless test photos were reproduced fairly well, but not too fast; it took about 2 minutes for each photograph.

At a price tag of Rs 8,999, the Photosmart offers good value for money.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB 2.0 interface, maximum resolution of 4800x1200, maximum paper size supported 4x6 inches, supports CompactFlash type I or II, SmartMedia, Memorystick, Multi Media Card or Secure Digital memory cards

HP Photosmart 130	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 8,999

Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd

Phone: 011-26826000

Fax: 011-26826053

E-mail: seema_dawar@hp.com

Web site: www.hpindia.com

Logitech MX500 Optical Mouse

Click away!

The MX500 uses optical technology, thus freeing you from the chore of regular maintenance. It has a host of buttons that are configurable for various applications. Its black and grey colour combination catches the eye.

Instead of close-fitting left and right buttons, the top surface of the mouse is made of one curved

piece of silver plastic. The surface splits in two towards the front, giving you the left and right buttons. The left side is curved inwards so that your thumb rests easily without much strain.

The MX models ship with Logitech MouseWare version 9.7, which covers Windows 95, 98, NT 4.0, Me, 2000, XP Professional and XP Home Edition, as well as Mac OS 8.6. We installed the mouse on Windows XP and the OS recognised it. But to configure

and make use of all the buttons, you will have to install the bundled applications. Ergonomically, the configuration is quite good, with all the buttons well-designed and well-placed for easy access.

As far as the gaming performance goes, the mouse performs really well. Although a tad heavier than a normal mouse, it feels and handles much better, even for extremely fast and intensive

Price: Rs 4,700

Contact: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-28260258

Fax: 022- 28221012

Web site: www.logitech.com

games such as *Quake III*.

Overall, the MX500 is a very well-balanced pointing device—great for desktop, business and gaming use. The only downside is its price—a stifling Rs 4,700.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB interface, optical sensors, 800 dpi resolution, maximum speed of 40 inches per second

Logitech MX500 Optical Mouse	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

WebCafe

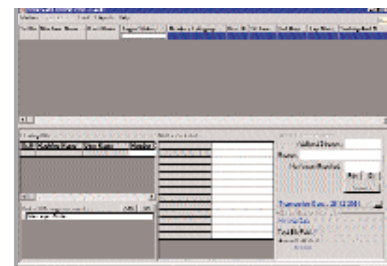
Cafe management made easy

WebCafe is a nifty cyber cafe management software that takes care of all of the everyday problems faced by cyber cafe owners such as recovering a formatted hard drive, cash inflow and calculations.

It offers a lot of benefits to both, administrators as well as clients, by preparing customised bills. Administrators can automatically get the bill as soon as the user logs off. You can also keep a track of machines that are in use and log off or shutdown any PC on the network or bar your customers from visiting certain Web sites by specifying typical words.

Apart from all the benefits to the owners, it's very useful to surfers as well—the client module can freeze the usage of all applications till the user has logged in. Thus, a surfer can fully optimise his

stay at the cyber cafe and not worry about the bill, as the timer can be frozen whenever he is not using the PC. Surfers can also check their bills anytime during their stay.



The program is advisable for big cyber cafes that need to manage a lot of PCs. A demo version of WebCafe is available on the Net for an evaluation period of 15 days.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Pentium-class CPU, 64 MB RAM, 20 GB hard disk drive, Windows 98 or higher

WebCafe	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 700 per client

Contact: Rhombus Tech Pvt Ltd

Phone: 022-28501416

Fax: 022-56926600

E-mail: contact@rhombustech-nologies.com

Web site: www.saysnetsoft.com

